



If the call is for a user on another network (another operator) the call is passed from the MSC to a gateway MSC that switches the call to the appropriate operator's MSC. Think of it as losing possession to the other team.



Here's where football stops making sense in the equation. Instead of play turning around, imagine if both teams wanted to attack the same goal... The call is carried forward from MSC to BSC to BTS and all the way to the base station of the called party's location.



There's also a home location register (HLR) that each operator maintains, which knows which phone is where (or latched on to which base station). Also, an authentication centre (AuC) checks whether the subscriber being called has the required authorisation and credentials to receive calls. So if you haven't paid your bill or furnished proper documents, the AuC is the one who gives you the red card – like a referee does.



When all goes well, the correct subscriber is connected to, and you hear ringing at your end, as the networks finally connect the two phones – it's like a forward taking a shot at the goal.



Of course it usually turns out to be a tele-marketeer, trying to sell you something you don't really want or need. So it's usually the mobile operator and the marketing companies that celebrate most of the calls that get through!



The called party hears his phone ring. Think of them as the opponent's goalie. If the call goes unanswered or is rejected, it's like a goalkeeper's save, and you start from scratch all over again.



When the call is answered, it's like a goal being scored, and the celebrations begin with a "Hello!"

